

Interactivity Via Phone Itself

20 concepts where the phone stops being a window and becomes an instrument

Where most interactive Bible concepts focus on what happens on the screen, these use what the phone itself can do — its battery, microphone, sensors, clock, location, haptics, and its neighbouring devices — so that the hardware carries theological weight. All are buildable with the standard web stack (three.js and browser Web APIs, no app store required).

Sensors as Theology

1. The Ten Virgins' Battery

Your phone's actual battery level is your lamp oil. The parable experience is only fully lit above 50%; below 20% the scene dims and the wise/foolish tension becomes personal.

Battery Status API + dynamic scene lighting.

2. Peace, Be Still (Room Noise Storm)

The Sea of Galilee storm rages in proportion to your real room's ambient noise. The waves only calm when your actual environment goes quiet.

Microphone amplitude → Gerstner wave intensity.

3. Still Small Voice

A game that rejects loud input. Shouting into the mic does nothing — wind, earthquake and fire particles roar past. Only whispering the verse advances Elijah out of the cave.

Volume-thresholded speech recognition, inverted.

4. Emmaus Road Pedometer

The story only unlocks as you physically walk. 11 km of cumulative real steps (over days) walks the road; the stranger's identity is revealed at journey's end.

Accelerometer step detection + persistent state.

5. Toward Jerusalem

Like a qibla compass: hold the phone flat and it points to Jerusalem from anywhere on earth, with distance and a Daniel 6 prayer prompt. Absurdly simple, weirdly moving.

Device Orientation API + great-circle math.

Time as a Mechanic

6. Manna

Daily content that cannot be hoarded. Today's reading vanishes at midnight; tapping "save for later" makes it rot (maggot particle shader). A double portion appears on Fridays.

Server time + expiring state.

7. Sabbath Mode

One day a week the app refuses to gamify. Streaks pause without penalty, all mechanics grey out, and it offers only stillness. An app that models rest is genuinely countercultural.

Scheduled state — the surprise is restraint.

8. Gethsemane Heartbeat

The phone vibrates with Jesus' heartbeat through the passion narrative — steady in the garden, racing at the arrest, stopping at 3pm, returning on Sunday. Read in the dark, phone against your palm.

Vibration API pattern sequencing.

9. The Watchman's Sunrise

Psalm 130 (“more than watchmen wait for the morning”): a night vigil scene whose lighting is locked to your real local sun. The dawn in the app arrives exactly when dawn arrives outside your window — and not one minute sooner.

Solar position calculation + real-time directional light.

10. Pentecost Rolling Wave

Once a year (or weekly at 9am local), a wind-and-fire event sweeps the live global user map timezone by timezone, hitting each teen at their own 9am, Acts 2 style. You can watch it coming toward you across the planet.

Scheduled global event + instanced world map.

The Senses Beyond Sight

11. Bartimaeus (Screen Off)

An entire experience with a black screen. Navigate Jericho's crowd toward Jesus' voice using spatial audio alone; sight is restored only at the end, when the scene renders for the first time.

Web Audio PositionalAudio; headphones required.

12. Thomas's Hands (Haptic Wounds)

Trace your finger across the 3D wounds; the phone answers with distinct haptic textures. Belief through touch, literally.

Pointer position → vibration waveform mapping.

13. The Twinkling of an Eye

Blink-detection via webcam. The resurrection transformation of 1 Corinthians 15:52 happens literally during your blink — you never see the change occur, only the before and after.

Face landmark detection + frame swap on eye-close.

The Real World Leaks In

14. Real Weather Windows

Scenes bind to your live local weather. Elijah's drought story is only playable when it's actually dry; the moment real rain hits your suburb, 1 Kings 18 erupts. Patience becomes a mechanic.

Weather API → shader states.

15. The Lost Coin (In Your Actual Room)

WebXR hides a virtual drachma somewhere in your real room. You sweep your phone's virtual lamplight across your actual floor until it glints. Then the app asks who you'll celebrate with.

WebXR hit-testing + spotlight shader.

16. Zacchaeus Lookup

AR that only triggers when you physically point the phone up — into a real tree if you can find one. Jesus' line “come down” plays only from above your head.

Camera + orientation gating.

Other Phones, Other People

17. Body of Christ Screen-Tiling

1 Corinthians 12 as hardware: each teen's phone renders one fragment of a scene. Only when the group physically lays phones edge-to-edge does the full image assemble and animate across all screens.

WebSockets + relative position handshake.

18. Babel Undone

Two teens on different continents speak into their phones in their own languages; each hears the other in their own tongue while a shared Pentecost scene builds between them.

WebRTC + live translation — sits right next to Max7 Live Translate.

Inverted Mechanics

19. 70×7 Shredder

Type a grievance. Watch it torn into Voronoi fragments and blown away — and the app keeps count toward 490, quietly making Peter's math absurd by week three.

Text-to-mesh fracture physics + persistent counter.

20. Fresco Restoration (Spaced Repetition in Disguise)

Verses you've memorized are painted as frescoes that genuinely weather and fade over real weeks. Return and recite to restore the pigment. Forgetting is visible.

Time-decayed textures + speech verification.